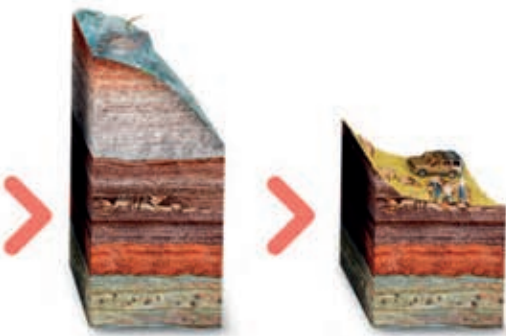


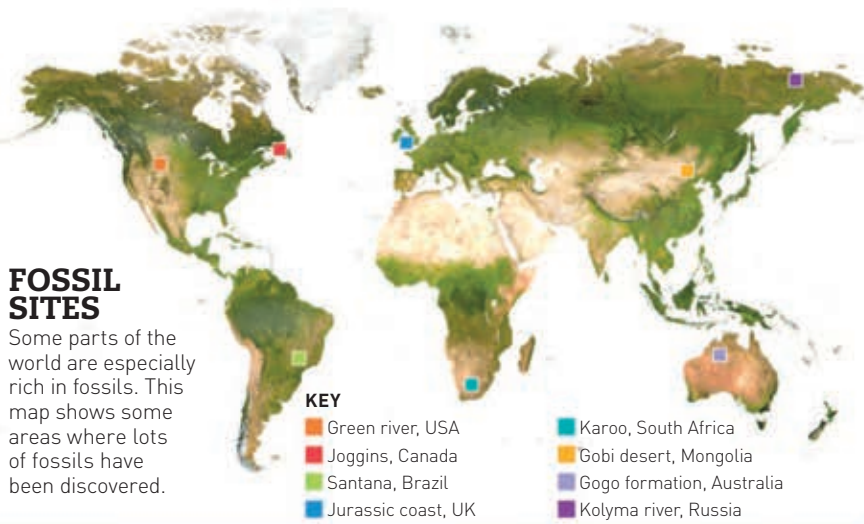


5 SURFACE EROSION
Fossilized remains of creatures begin to be revealed as the land is eroded slowly over thousands of years.

6 EXCAVATION
Fossils are excavated by being carefully freed from the rock that has long surrounded them.

FOSSIL SITES

Some parts of the world are especially rich in fossils. This map shows some areas where lots of fossils have been discovered.



FOSSIL TYPES

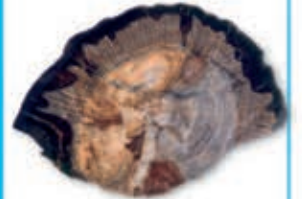
Fossils may be formed from the remains of plants or animals, or from traces of their activities during life.



TRACE FOSSIL
These are fossils showing animal activity, such as footprints, burrows, or nests.



IMPRESSIONS
These are fossils where the animal or plant body has decayed completely but left an impression in the sediment.



PETRIFICATION
This type of fossil is formed when minerals crystallize inside the body cells, preserving them in stone.



NATURAL CAST
In cast fossils, sediment hardens in natural gaps inside an animal, such as the inside of a shell.

VERTEBRATES

Fossils of vertebrate animals are some of the most exciting fossils ever found. They reveal species – such as dinosaurs and flying reptiles – that existed millions of years ago.



PARADOXIDES



CONSTELLARIA



AMMONITE



REMAINS OF HOMOEOSAURUS



BONY RAY-FINNED FISH



DINOSAUR VERTEBRA



DINOSAUR VERTEBRA



PLIOSAUR SKULL



MAMMAL-LIKE REPTILE SKULL



JAW OF THECODONTOSAURUS



UPPER CHEEK TOOTH OF A MAMMOTH



PANTHERA LOWER JAW



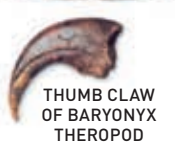
GALLIMIMUS SKULL



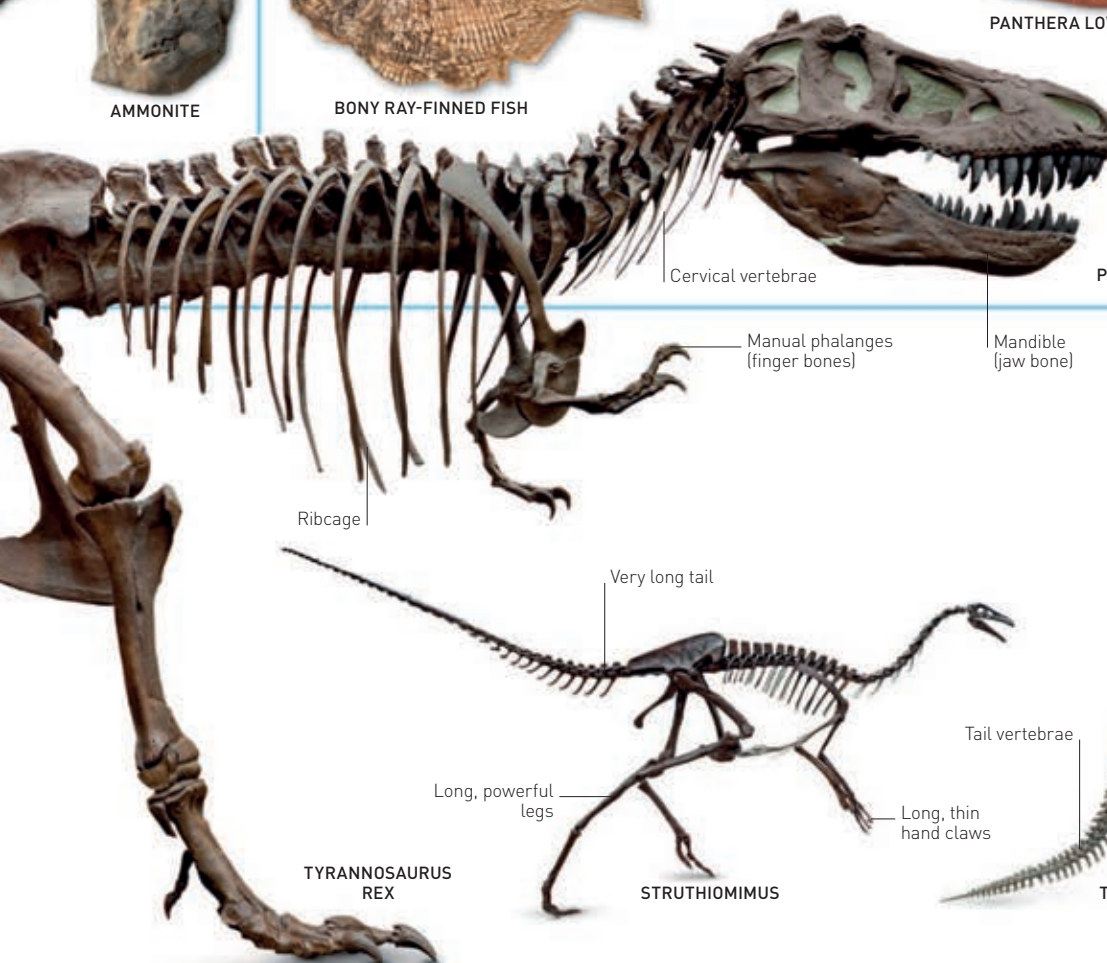
PRIMITIVE FROG



OVIRAPTOR PHILOCERATOPS EGG



THUMB CLAW OF BARYONYX THEROPOD



Cervical vertebrae

Manual phalanges (finger bones)

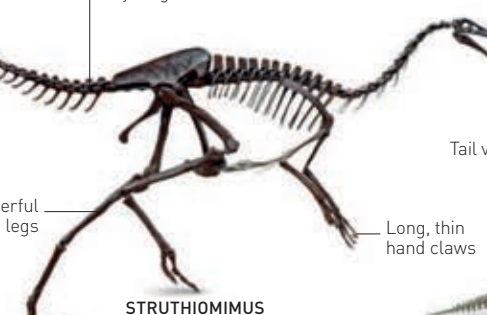
Mandible (jaw bone)

Ribcage

Very long tail

Long, powerful legs

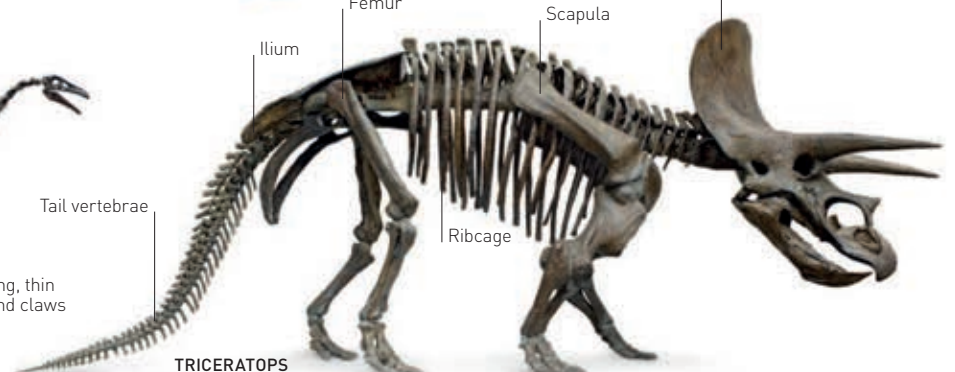
TYRANNOSAURUS REX



STRUTHIOMIMUS

Long, thin hand claws

Tail vertebrae



TRICERATOPS

DINOSAUR FOSSILS HAVE BEEN DISCOVERED ON EVERY CONTINENT, INCLUDING ANTARCTICA

Ilium

Femur

Scapula

Large, bony frill

Ribcage